Avarna Jain, Global Chairperson of the Women's Business Alliance at the BRICS Summit 2026



Avarna Jain served as Global Chair of the BRICS Women's Business Alliance in 2026, leading the Alliance through India's BRICS Chairship. She also separately chaired the Working Group on Creative Industries. Under her leadership, the Alliance hosted the BRICS WBA Women-Led Development Summit 2026 in New Delhi, bringing together Chapter Chairs, Working Group leaders, and delegates from across BRICS nations.

In her opening remarks at the Summit, Avarna framed the Alliance's mandate around a central idea: that progress happens when ideas, capital, and experience cross borders — and that women's full participation in business, investment, and leadership is core to building more resilient and innovative economies. Under her leadership, the Alliance released a dedicated knowledge paper on India's Digital Public Infrastructure alongside seven BRICS-wide resources for its member nations.



On September 11, Avarna delivered remarks at the BRICS Business Forum at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi, alongside Union Ministers S. Jaishankar and Piyush Goyal and senior leaders from across BRICS nations. She made the case that the competitiveness of BRICS economies depends on mobilising their full talent pool — women included in strategy from the outset, not brought in after decisions are made — and pointed again to India's JAM Trinity, with over 32.9 crore women now holding Jan Dhan accounts, as a model to build on.

"But at a Business Forum, I believe we must take that conversation one step further. Women-led development must also mean women-led economic